

Southern Islands

Written as a doctoral thesis for University in Sargin
915 NE, Naevin Manaut

Author Context

Naevin Manaut is now-professor of foreign policies in Sargin's university. While he is a baedoorian born in Sargin in late XVIII century, he also has erdic roots through mother who migrated to Baedoor and married a baedoorian man. That is also the reason why the author focuses on erdic culture in his work, counting his doctoral thesis ("Brief Overview of Erdic Culture") and "Southern Islands", written four years later. Both publications were published by the university.

Naevin visited Kaer lands twice – first, as a material of research for his doctoral thesis, which he travelled with his mother. His second trip was two years later, for the book below, which he took alone, using university funds.

Book Context

While Naevin takes pride in his origins, he also is fully baedoorian in his mindset, meaning national pride that is visible throughout his writing. What shows however his influences is a little more nuanced take on goblins, which pure baedoorian scholars would either omit or consider equal to animals. That being said, the bias against them can still be seen, even in the sheer fact of not mentioning hostility of baedoorians.

Despite their relative vicinity to our beloved fatherland, and our state taking interest in those places for over a millennia, there is little high quality, academic material written on the southern islands of Baedoor Continent. I write this book with hope that a short introduction to the lands of the south will bring interest in our academic space, to dive more deeply into the interesting meanderings of the cultures residing there.

The territory collectively referred to as the Southern Islands encompasses roughly the same area as Baedoor Island, and is demarcated into many biomes equally intriguing as the latter. The two largest islands are known as Kaer and Arennan. {add single sentence overviews of K and A}

Dotted in between are many smaller islands, {add comment re their importance/population}, the most principal one of import of these being known as Kacari – the true gem of Erdic civilization.

Kaer

Kaer, the northern island, is covered in dense, dark coniferous forests spanning its entire width, the island bisected by the glittering Mavsvi River. Tall coniferous trees and rocky soil dappled with rare flowering meadows grace the darkest depths of the woods. The aforementioned Mavsvi River passes from the Nemori mountain range of the east to the western deltas, with southern regions of the island cut through by meandering rivers. Civilization is thus more concentrated towards the southern regions, where the mild climate from the moderating effect of the ocean, fertile farmland and plentiful timber, and rich bounty of seafood make for a comfortable life.



Kaer is inhabited by three central civilisations and multiple goblin tribes. The northmost lands are inhabited by Kaerians, referring to themselves as *serj*, who are descendants of Nomathian tribes that roamed Baedoor in the Old Era. The society of the Kaerians shows their shared heartsblood with the Baedoorians – they are skilled, industrious craftsmen, dedicated to the continued development and

uplifting of their culture. Their settled lands are fertile and rich in resources, granting excellent extractive potential. This in no doubt demonstrates the drive that has led to the Kaerians' current economic prowess, despite settlement of the island less than two centuries ago – in exemplary contrast to the primitive goblins

inhabiting the northern reaches of the island, unable to utilize these resources to their potential.

Kaerians share their northern territories with goblins, and similarly to their ancestors from Baedoor Island, treat them as allies. It's worth noting, however, that occupation of the Old Empire has led to the erosion of this bond, with the goblins perhaps not unduly shying away from human settlements since. {explain what the old empire is and relation to the goblins} Little is known about the goblins, as most places they reside in are unreasonably dangerous for the few academics oddly wanting to study their savage culture – excluding mention of the goblins' vile nature and outward hostility.

In the southwestern territories resides the ancient civilisation of the Kehts. They take up space between the western deltas and southern forests {replace with delta/forest name} up to the border of the Erdic Kingdom. Scattered outposts and villages are rumored to be found in the northern forests, but are difficult to find due to poorly maintained roads.

Kehtic culture is highly decentralized and authoritarian. Multiple states, oftentimes establishing a regional religious sect, reign over small territories of kehtic land. In contrast to the otherwise decentralized and chaotic structure, Kehts are also ruled by the kingly figure of the queen, *djehvol*, who reigns with ultimate authority. She resides in the ancient Kehtic capital, Dahekhريس.

Kehtic economy is primarily agrarian, or based on extraction of fundamental resources such as timber or ore. However, dedicated magical research has helped keep their society stable {how?}.

Due in part to the comparative dearth of natural resources, as well as the oppressive state limiting the free flow of enterprise {elaborate}, Kehtic citizens are rather poor, unlike their Erdic and Kaerian neighbors situated on the coasts.

Finally, the Erdic civilization may perhaps be the oldest of those in the area, and certainly the most grand. The Erdic population is most significant in the southeastern coast, concentrated around the bustling Bristeldir port which additionally serves as the main administrative and trading hub. The dense, colorful city is a wonderful example of classical Erdic architecture – wood houses composed of simple shapes topped with elegant sloping roofs appear deceptively simple from afar, but upon closer inspection reveal the most intricate scrollwork, both painted and carved, evoking the natural majesty of the wind, clouds and ocean waves. Powerfully perfumed climbing vines and fruit trees alongside glass windchimes hanging from painted eaves complete the sensory tapestry. Doors and shutters are adorned with images of native flowers in full bloom, if they are visible through the glorious gardens maintained both within and without the home, the plants viewed as part of one's own family.

This ties back to the path of The Garden – one central to Erdic philosophy – a concept under which every Erd must maintain their self, family, home, city, and land for it to thrive. As with the seasons, the Erd cycles through life and death – as a single ant in a pillar of moving black. One's own self responsibility – their Garden – is their whole, their self, and their spirit.

Erdic culture has a long, rich heritage dating back to the Pre Era, with the arts and cultural works reflecting this finely developed aesthetic and spiritual sensibility.

Kacari

The true epicenter of Erdic civilisation is Kacari, an island south of Kaer housing the



biggest city in the southern lands – Roda.

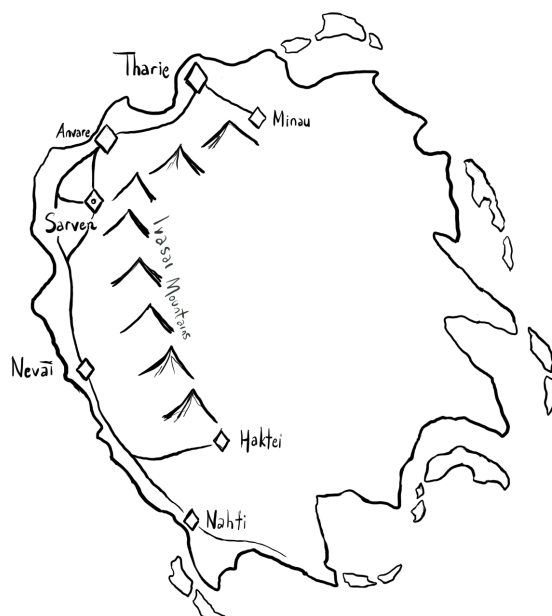
While Bristeldir serves as the local administrative port, Roda is the true jewel of Erdic culture, spanning across the whole Kacari's bay, cradled by the ledges of the surrounding {Name} mountain range.

Kacari is a relatively peaceful place, thriving on the peace achieved with the {Treaty of X} after the {War of the name} concluded in {year}. The island itself is a destination for many pilgrimages and is considered a central point of the island chain for many traders, including those of Baedoor. There are many small monasteries buried in the deep woods endowing almost the entirety of the island.

As a small yet significant footnote, the other lesser island of import is known as Disane which, albeit tiny, served as a paramount buffer zone during {War of the name} for the Erdic forces to defend against the invading Saphtris. {run on sentence, rephrase} The island itself passed between hands multiple times during that period, only to be finally gifted back to the Erdic Kingdom under Baedoorian rule – itself a largely forgotten footnote in history.

Arennan

Arennan is the southernmost island of the continent, and features a dry, arid climate with sparse rainfall. Covered almost entirely by dry, warm biomes, ranging from desert on the east, steppes on the south, to sparse savannah regions located on the west, the island itself cut through



by the slithering Ivasai mountain range.

The majority of settled lands are located on the west, where Saphtric civilisation has existed for many millennia. According to their mythology, the land of Arennan was once created with greenery, but its desertification is now an established fact that is progressing. {rephrase and give mythological cause why}

Saphtris are tall, yellow-skinned Tri {give physical description of other races too, or remove this line}, a civilisation of uncertain origins that settled on Arennan in the old days of the Pre Era. Their culture is one built upon religious stories, military and technology, with the latter perhaps being a necessary measure for surviving on such an unfriendly land.

Saphtric cities are built primarily on coasts, perhaps in part due to the strong emphasis of the Saphtris on their naval forces. Saphtris have a long history of engaging in naval-focused wars, notably the {war of the name}, fought the Erdic Kingdom, and a {spurned/successful} invasion of the obscure continent little-known to the laypeople known as Ixathei.